## A3. Call out one gap or anomaly

Gap/Anomaly: Cold Pressed Coconut Oil 500ml shows a noticeable month-on-month sales decline, from ₹108,242 in June to ₹81,652 in July, a drop of about 24.5%.

What I'd check next: I would check whether the decline is concentrated in a particular distributor, beat, or outlet, and then verify whether it was caused by stock availability, reduced outlet activity, or lower demand.

## PART B: Case Questions

**B1. KPI Dip Investigation (20% MoM Drop)**

In the given data, **Trichy Central Distributors** stands out, with sales value falling from about **₹2.01 lakh in June to ₹1.25 lakh in July, a 37.8% drop**. I would then check whether this is also reflected in outlet activity. Here, active outlets fell from **13 to 9, around a 31% drop**, and quantity sold also decreased by about **32%**. So, the sales decline appears to be linked to lower outlet activity as well.

From the available data, I can check the distributor, outlet, SKU, sales value, and quantity. I would use these to identify whether the decline is concentrated in particular outlets or products. However, information such as **stock-outs, missed sales visits, order frequency, returns, and the exact reason why an outlet became inactive is not available here**. I would therefore check these in the RTA/DMS platform and confirm them with the field sales team.

I would also cross-check the figures against the source data to rule out any data-entry or reporting issues. Finally, I would discuss the affected outlets or beats with the team or relevant stakeholder to understand whether the drop was caused by reduced coverage, stock availability, lower demand, or another operational issue.

**B2. Messy Multi-Source Reporting Architecture**

I would first collect the four sheets and check whether the columns, dates, SKU names, channel names and sales values are consistent. I would also check how each person is maintaining the data and whether the same KPI is being calculated differently.

If the reporting is being done in **Excel**, I would use **Power Query** to clean and standardize the data and, if required, **append** the different sales sources into one consolidated dataset. If I need additional information from another table, such as SKU or product details, I would use **Merge** based on a common key.

If the company is already using **Power BI**, I would use Power Query and the Power BI model for the reporting instead. If they are using **Microsoft Fabric**, I would follow the existing setup there.

I would keep the raw data separate, add basic checks for duplicates and missing data, and make the process refreshable so that the weekly report does not have to be created manually every time.

**B3. Ad-Hoc Request Scoping: "Which outlets should we stop servicing?"**

Before touching the data, I would first understand **the reason the Founder's Office wants to stop servicing certain outlets**. I would ask whether the concern is low sales, low profitability, high servicing cost, inactive outlets, or some other business reason.

Then, I would look at the outlet-level data available to me, such as **sales value, quantity and outlet activity**, and identify outlets that consistently show low or declining performance. If the decision is based on profitability or servicing cost, I would need that additional data because it is not available in the current sales data.

I would initially prepare a simple table showing the **outlet, sales, activity, trend and key observation**. I would use this to identify outlets that need further investigation and then discuss those outlets with the relevant stakeholder or field team before making any decision to stop servicing them.